ScholarHub Setup Guide

Open the project in VS Code and run it on your computer.

Run the project

1 Install two programs

- **Visual Studio Code** from code.visualstudio.com
- **Node.js** (the LTS version) from nodejs.org

2 Open the project folder

In VS Code click **File** → **Open Folder**, choose **ScholarHubProject**, then click **Yes, I trust the authors**.

3 Open the terminal

Click **Terminal** → **New Terminal**. A panel opens at the bottom. You type the commands there.

4 Install the project (first time only)

```
npm run install:all
```

Wait until it finishes.

5 Add the settings file (first time only)

The project needs a file named `.env` inside the `server` folder. It holds the database password.

- If the project owner gave you a `.env` file, put it in the `server` folder.
- If not, copy `server/.env.example`, rename the copy to `.env`, and fill in `DATABASE_URL` and `JWT_SECRET`.

6 Start the project

```
npm start
```

7 Open it in your browser

```
http://localhost:5173
```

8 **Stop the project**

Click inside the terminal and press **Ctrl + C**. Next time, only do steps 2, 3, 6 and 7.

Where to find the code

Folder or file	What it has
`client/src/pages`	The website pages (login, dashboard, forms)
`client/src/components`	Parts reused on many pages
`server/server.js`	The back end that saves and loads data
`database/schema.sql`	The database tables

Click a file in the list on the left to open it. Press **Ctrl + P** (Mac: **Cmd + P**) to open a file by typing its name.

If something goes wrong

Problem	Fix
`npm` is not recognized	Install Node.js, then close and reopen VS Code.
Database or login error	Check the `server/.env` file (step 5).
Port is already in use	Close the other terminals that are running the project, then run `npm start` again.